

DriftDater User Manual & Feature Walkthrough

This manual explains how to set up, run, and use the DriftDater full-stack dating application built with Vue.js, Flask, and PostgreSQL.

Overview

- Users can register and login.
- Users can create and edit dating profiles.
- Users can browse, like, pass, and save profiles for later.
- Users can create matches and send messages to each other once matched.

Backend Setup

- Open PowerShell in the project folder.
- Activate the virtual environment with: `.\venv\Scripts\activate`
- Run the backend using: `flask --app app --debug run`
- Backend runs on `http://127.0.0.1:8080`

Frontend Setup

- Open another terminal in the project folder.
- Run `npm install`.
- Run `npm run dev`.
- Frontend runs on `http://localhost:5173`

Registration and Login

- Users register with username, email, and password.
- Duplicate usernames and emails are prevented.
- Navbar updates dynamically after login.

Profile Features

- Users can create profiles with images, bio, location, age, and interests.
- Relationship type uses a dropdown menu.
- Profiles can be edited later.

Dashboard Features

- Browse suggested profiles.
- Like or pass users.
- Save favourite profiles.

- View match scores.

Matches and Messaging

- Mutual likes create matches.
- Matches appear on the Matches page.
- Users can send and receive messages.

Search Features

- Users can search profiles using filters.
- Filters include age dropdowns and gender selection.

Saved Profiles

- Users can bookmark profiles.
- Saved profiles appear on the Saved Profiles page.

Security Features

- Session authentication is used.
- Protected routes prevent unauthorized access.
- Users can only edit their own profiles